

Team AI Readiness Sprint

A structured readiness process for teams that want to identify useful AI opportunities before buying tools or launching policies.

Format	Two or three Zoom sessions with discovery worksheets and a readiness summary.
Level	Level 3: organizational readiness and use-case discovery
Audience	Small and midsize companies, nonprofits, health care teams, and institutions that need cautious, practical alignment.

Learner outcomes

- Map current work patterns, friction points, comfort levels, and risk concerns.
- Rank possible AI use cases by value, risk, readiness, and training needs.
- Clarify what to train, what to pilot, what to postpone, and what not to do.
- Create a practical readiness map before buying tools or announcing large AI initiatives.

Guiding questions

- Where are people already experimenting, and where are they hesitant?
- Which tasks create friction, delay, rework, or knowledge bottlenecks?
- Which ideas are low-risk training candidates, and which need stronger review before action?
- What should we learn before spending money on tools or vendors?

Readiness checks

- The team can distinguish training needs from implementation or procurement needs.
- Use cases are ranked by value, risk, readiness, and review burden.
- Sensitive-data concerns are named without implying legal or compliance guarantees.
- Next steps are limited enough to learn from safely.

Research-backed adoption practices

- Start discovery by asking where the business spends most of its time and what important work is being neglected.
- Combine top-down priorities with worker voice so use cases reflect real operations, not only leadership guesses.
- Score each idea by value, risk, readiness, data sensitivity, review burden, and learning required.
- Separate train, pilot, wait, avoid, and specialist-review decisions before spending money on tools.

Curriculum modules

Team context scan

We identify where AI curiosity already exists, where anxiety is highest, and where work is repetitive or overloaded.

Use-case discovery

Participants collect possible use cases and sort them by task type, data sensitivity, and expected value.

Risk and readiness scoring

We use a simple matrix to distinguish low-risk practice from decisions that need stronger review or policy.

Training path recommendation

The sprint ends with a practical next-step map for briefings, workshops, office hours, or a limited pilot.

Governance questions for later

The sprint names policy, procurement, privacy, and implementation questions that should be handled by the right internal owners.

Session flow

Discover

Interview or workshop with leaders and users to surface real work patterns, pain points, and comfort levels.

Inventory

Collect possible use cases and describe each one by task type, data sensitivity, value, and review needs.

Score

Rank ideas with a simple value, risk, readiness, and training-needs rubric.

Sort

Place ideas into train, pilot, wait, or avoid categories.

Recommend

Translate findings into a short next-step roadmap for training, office hours, or a narrow pilot.

Practice labs

Friction mapping

Identify where teams lose time to drafting, summarizing, searching, rework, planning, or coordination.

Use-case card sorting

Turn vague AI ideas into comparable cards with audience, input, output, review, and risk fields.

Value-risk matrix

Place candidate use cases on the grid and discuss what belongs in training, pilot, wait, or avoid.

Readiness narrative

Draft a plain-language summary leaders can use to explain the next step without overpromising.

1-2 hour utility projects

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

How to choose a strong first project

- Real work, low risk: choose a task people already recognize, but keep inputs public, fictional, or sanitized.
- Clear walk-away artifact: produce a brief, agenda, checklist, glossary, comparison table, or reusable prompt sequence.
- Visible judgment step: check claims, name uncertainty, revise tone, or decide what should remain human-led.
- Transferable habit: practice a pattern the learner can reuse later, such as giving context, comparing outputs, or verifying before relying.

Learning Sprint (60-75 minutes)

Turn a confusing topic into a private tutor session.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page explainer, a short quiz, a glossary, and a list of what to verify elsewhere.

Safe input: Use a public topic, a public article, or a concept you want to understand. Avoid private client, patient, employee, or proprietary material.

- Ask for a plain-language explanation at your current level.
- Request examples, analogies, common misconceptions, and a five-question quiz.
- Ask what claims need source checking before you rely on them.

Starter prompt: Teach me [topic] as a smart beginner. Start with a plain-language explanation, then give examples, common misconceptions, a short glossary, a five-question quiz, and a list of claims I should verify with reliable sources.

Decision Clarity Brief (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to make a decision easier to think about without outsourcing the decision.

Walk-away artifact: A comparison table, assumptions list, pre-mortem, missing-information checklist, and final decision questions.

Safe input: Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Describe the options, constraints, values, and what would count as success.
- Ask AI to compare options and surface assumptions instead of choosing for you.
- Run a pre-mortem and identify what a human should check before acting.

Starter prompt: Help me think through this decision without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Create criteria, compare options, name assumptions, run a pre-mortem, list missing information, and end with questions I should answer myself.

Meeting Prep Kit (60-90 minutes)

Turn a rough meeting idea into a more useful conversation.

Walk-away artifact: A meeting agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template.

Safe input: Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Give AI the purpose, audience, desired outcome, and any safe background.
- Ask for an agenda, questions, risks, and decisions to clarify.
- Revise the agenda for tone, time, and who needs to review it.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a focused agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template. Mark anything that needs human confirmation: [context].

Writing Upgrade Studio (60 minutes)

See how AI can draft, critique, and revise with you in a loop.

Walk-away artifact: A stronger email, memo, bio, announcement, or short article with a revision history and review checklist.

Safe input: Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Ask for a first rewrite for a specific audience and tone.
- Ask AI to critique its own draft for clarity, claims, tone, and missing context.
- Request a final revision and make the last edits yourself.

Starter prompt: Improve this rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone. Then critique your revision for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything a human should verify before sending: [safe draft].

Research Compass (90-120 minutes)

Use AI to plan research before you read, search, or cite.

Walk-away artifact: A research question map, search terms, source categories, red flags, and verification plan.

Safe input: Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Ask AI to turn a broad topic into better questions and search terms.
- Request source categories, possible biases, and missing perspectives.
- Use the output as a reading plan, then verify claims in actual sources.

Starter prompt: Help me plan research on [public topic]. Create key questions, search terms, source types to seek, likely blind spots, red flags, and a verification checklist. Do not make final claims without sources.

Workflow Recipe Builder (90-120 minutes)

Turn one repeated task into a reusable AI-assisted workflow.

Walk-away artifact: A workflow recipe with inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, human owner, and when-not-to-use guidance.

Safe input: Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Map the task into steps, inputs, outputs, review points, and handoffs.
- Ask AI where it can help and where human judgment should stay in charge.
- Create a repeatable prompt sequence and a review checklist.

Starter prompt: Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include purpose, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review checkpoints, human decision points, risks, and when not to use AI for this task.

Professional Profile Refresh (75-90 minutes)

Use AI as a coach for describing your work more clearly.

Walk-away artifact: A refreshed bio, resume bullet options, interview talking points, and confidence-building practice questions.

Safe input: Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Give AI a safe summary of your work, audience, and desired tone.
- Ask for clearer positioning, bullet options, and examples of evidence to add.
- Roleplay interview questions and revise anything that feels inflated or inaccurate.

Starter prompt: Using this sanitized professional summary, help me describe my work more clearly. Draft a short bio, five resume bullet options, three interview talking points, and questions I should answer to make the claims more accurate: [summary].

Personal Planning Co-Pilot (60-75 minutes)

Use AI to turn vague goals into a realistic plan you can actually follow.

Walk-away artifact: A one-week plan, prioritized task list, obstacle plan, review ritual, and next-action checklist.

Safe input: Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, constraints, time available, and what has made it hard.
- Ask AI for a practical plan with tradeoffs and small next actions.
- Review the plan yourself and remove anything unrealistic or intrusive.

Starter prompt: Help me turn this goal into a realistic one-week plan: [safe goal]. Ask clarifying questions if needed, then create priorities, daily actions, likely obstacles, a review ritual, and a simple checklist.

Tangible cases

Nonprofit intake backlog

Situation: A nonprofit team spends too much time sorting public inquiries, drafting first responses, and preparing internal handoffs.

Learner task: Map the workflow, identify safe practice points, and decide which steps are training candidates rather than automation projects.

Starter prompt: Analyze this fictional nonprofit intake workflow. Identify friction points, possible AI training opportunities, data sensitivity concerns, review needs, and whether each idea belongs in train, pilot, wait, or avoid: [fictional workflow].

Clinic admin documentation

Situation: A health care organization wants to improve admin templates but is cautious about patient privacy and medical claims.

Learner task: Separate generic documentation practice from anything requiring internal privacy, clinical, legal, or compliance owners.

Starter prompt: Given this fictional clinic admin workflow, list low-risk AI training ideas, items that require private systems or internal approval, and items to avoid. Do not provide medical, legal, compliance, or cybersecurity assurances: [fictional workflow].

Customer support knowledge gaps

Situation: A small company has scattered public FAQ pages and repeated support questions.

Learner task: Score possible use cases by value, risk, readiness, and review burden before any tool purchase.

Starter prompt: Turn these fictional support pain points into use-case cards. For each card, include task, user, input, output, value, risk, readiness, review owner, and recommended next step: [pain points].

Prompt library

Friction map

Help a team map workflow friction. Ask for recurring tasks, delays, rework, handoffs, knowledge bottlenecks, and sensitive-data concerns. Then summarize likely AI training opportunities.

Use-case card

Create a use-case card for this AI idea with user, task, input, output, value, risk, data sensitivity, review owner, readiness, and training need: [idea].

Value-risk scoring

Score these AI ideas from 1 to 5 for value, risk, readiness, and review burden. Explain each score and sort the ideas into train, pilot, wait, or avoid: [ideas].

Readiness summary

Draft a cautious readiness summary for leaders. Include what the team is ready to learn, what should be postponed, what needs specialist review, and the smallest practical next step: [findings].

Materials to develop

- Team readiness worksheet
- Use-case scoring rubric
- AI norms discussion guide
- Recommended next-step summary template
- Use-case card deck
- Train, pilot, wait, avoid decision sheet

Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Use-case value/risk grid
- Team adoption pathway from discovery to practice
- Readiness map from friction points to training path
- AI adoption value scan: time spent, neglected work, value, risk, next step

Follow-up work

- Choose two low-risk training candidates and one idea to postpone.
- Schedule the right briefing or workshop for the highest-priority audience.
- Review the map monthly as team fluency and tool options change.

Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.